



would be wonderful if he becomes the home minister of India and not just of the Centre. It's not his job. He can't be running police stations at the ground level. Yes, he can coordinate better and create a better ambience, but he can't be running the security apparatus of the whole country. I am not an admirer of his predecessor Shivraj Patil but it was completely nonsensical to say Patil must go because there has been a terror attack in Mumbai. Protecting Mumbai is the job of the Mumbai Police, in coordination with the other agencies. Is the Mumbai police better off today? The National Security Guards (NSG) and Force One of the Mumbai Police have been allocated land which has been encroached by a builder and a slum colony.

One can meet all the DGs in the country but are the DGs running a police force that can be effective? No. Orissa has a sanctioned strength of 207 IPS cadres. It has 84 officers in place. There are 30-40 per cent capacity deficits in leadership at different levels in the state police forces. You can coordinate all you like and pass any law in the country but who will implement this law? You can do nothing with 1.2 judges per lakh population when worldwide, it is between 11 and 39. A police force can't do its job efficiently because it doesn't have the capacity to do so. The IB has improved tremendously, in terms of coordination, but what about capacity building? There is, moreover, a certain critical mass below which no augmentation is going to diminish our vulnerabilities. See the training of police forces: raw recruits are being thrown into special operations groups after 13 weeks of training.

Chidambaram is doing a good job but it is not his exclusive job to protect India. The rest of the system is still dysfunctional and the accumulated capacity deficits are so great and the rate of redressal so slow that Chidambaram's efforts will soon be overtaken by challenges. You can celebrate 11 months without any terror incident but it has nothing to do with any response that we have put in

KIRAN BEDI

Terror is tackled by the footsoldiers. Chidambaram has only reached the central police organisations.

While we may approve of some of the actions taken so far to prevent terror strikes, I am far from being satisfied.



There is still no objective assessment of police performance and its impact on us.

The responses are not truly corrective, but only reactive. Chidambaram has to start grooming leadership.

Leadership can be groomed by spreading good practices, systems, responses and HR policies down the line.

AJAI SAHNI



Our expectations are high, but standards have fallen so low that we idolise people for doing their jobs.

No terror incident for 11 months has nothing to do with any response that we have put in place. We are still very vulnerable.

Orissa has a sanctioned strength of 207 IPS cadres, but has only 84. There are 30-40 per cent capacity deficits in leadership at different levels.

Chidambaram can't be running police stations at the ground level. It's not his job.

The National Security Guards has been allocated land in Mumbai that has already been encroached upon.